ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

The Book Launch Planning Workbook

A structured workbook for planning a thoughtful, manageable book release campaign.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

A launch is a coordinated set of decisions and activities, not a single day of posting. This workbook helps authors define goals, organise assets, coordinate people and prepare for uncertainty. Adapt the timeline to the publishing route, genre, budget and actual release date.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

Contents

01	Define what a successful launch means
02	Set the release strategy
03	Know the audience before the calendar
04	Write the launch positioning
05	Create the launch brief
06	Work backwards from publication day
07	Build a realistic budget
08	Assign owners and decisions
09	Prepare the book page
10	Coordinate the launch assets
11	Plan advance reader copies
12	Write outreach messages
13	Plan author-platform content
14	Plan email communication
15	Prepare launch partners
16	Design the launch-week rhythm
17	Prepare for launch-day operations
18	Coordinate a series launch
19	Use events with a clear purpose
20	Handle reviews ethically
21	Monitor without obsessing
22	Respond to reader questions
23	Manage setbacks
24	Extend the campaign after launch

25	Review the first 7 days
26	Review the first 30 days
27	Plan the next 90 days
28	Protect the author’s energy
29	Launch readiness sign-off
30	Post-launch learning record

01 / FIELD GUIDE

Define what a successful launch means

Choose outcomes that matter to this book and this author. Examples include reaching a defined reader segment, collecting early reader feedback, generating qualified attention or supporting a series. Avoid goals that depend entirely on platform-controlled rankings.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **define what a successful launch means**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

02 / FIELD GUIDE

Set the release strategy

Confirm whether the book is a first release, relaunch, revised edition, series continuation or seasonal title. Each has different constraints and opportunities. Document the reason for the chosen timing.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **set the release strategy**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

03 / FIELD GUIDE

Know the audience before the calendar

Describe the readers, their interests, where they discover books and what information helps them decide. A calendar built before audience understanding often becomes a list of disconnected posts.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **know the audience before the calendar**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

04 / FIELD GUIDE

Write the launch positioning

Create a concise message that explains what the book offers and why the intended reader might care. Prepare short, medium and long versions for different contexts.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write the launch positioning**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

05 / FIELD GUIDE

Create the launch brief

Record book facts, author details, approved claims, links, dates, assets, responsibilities, budget and approval process. Make one version the source of truth for collaborators.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create the launch brief**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

06 / FIELD GUIDE

Work backwards from publication day

Set milestones for final files, retailer setup, cover assets, outreach, announcements, proofing and contingency. Add buffers for platform processing and supplier delays.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **work backwards from publication day**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

07 / FIELD GUIDE

Build a realistic budget

List essential, optional and experimental expenses. Include design, editing, printing, advertising, event costs, software and professional support. Define a stop-loss point before spending begins.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a realistic budget**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

08 / FIELD GUIDE

Assign owners and decisions

Name who approves copy, who uploads files, who answers enquiries and who monitors campaign activity. If one person owns every task, reduce scope and schedule protected work time.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **assign owners and decisions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

09 / FIELD GUIDE

Prepare the book page

Check description, cover, author details, formats, price, series data, sample and links. Review the page as a reader and confirm that it is accurate in each relevant territory.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare the book page**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

10 / FIELD GUIDE

Coordinate the launch assets

Create reusable assets with consistent book facts and visual identity. Prepare alternate sizes and text descriptions. Store approved files in a shared folder with clear names and version dates.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate the launch assets**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

11 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan advance reader copies

Decide whether ARC outreach is appropriate, how readers will be selected, what format they will receive and when. Be explicit that participation and reviews are voluntary and outcomes cannot be guaranteed.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan advance reader copies**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

12 / FIELD GUIDE

Write outreach messages

Personalise messages to the recipient and explain why the book may interest them. Include only necessary details, a clear response path and a respectful opt-out. Avoid mass unsolicited pressure.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write outreach messages**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

13 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan author-platform content

Choose a few recurring themes: the book’s premise, research or inspiration, character or topic insights, author perspective and reader questions. Adapt each idea to the channel rather than cross-posting identical copy everywhere.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan author-platform content**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

14 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan email communication

Segment by consent and relevance. Make each message useful, concise and accurate. Set expectations for frequency and provide a clear unsubscribe mechanism.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan email communication**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

15 / FIELD GUIDE

Prepare launch partners

If working with bookstores, libraries, podcasts, bloggers or community organisers, confirm requirements early. Share a concise media sheet and respect each partner’s lead time.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare launch partners**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

16 / FIELD GUIDE

Design the launch-week rhythm

Give each day a purpose. Balance announcements, useful context, reader engagement and rest. Keep a small backup plan for a missed post or technical problem.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **design the launch-week rhythm**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

17 / FIELD GUIDE

Prepare for launch-day operations

Check the live page, links, purchase formats, email inbox and social profiles. Decide who handles corrections and how to communicate any delay without speculation.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare for launch-day operations**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

18 / FIELD GUIDE

Coordinate a series launch

For a sequel, make the reading order and previous-book entry point clear. Prepare a consistent series visual system and explain how the new release relates to earlier books.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate a series launch**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

19 / FIELD GUIDE

Use events with a clear purpose

An event should serve a defined audience and have a useful format: conversation, reading, workshop or Q&A.; Confirm venue, accessibility, permissions, timing and follow-up.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use events with a clear purpose**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

20 / FIELD GUIDE

Handle reviews ethically

Do not dictate review sentiment, require positive reviews or offer rewards for favourable opinions. Follow retailer and review-platform rules and disclose any material connection.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **handle reviews ethically**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

21 / FIELD GUIDE

Monitor without obsessing

Set specific times to check results. Record meaningful signals and operational issues, but avoid refreshing rankings throughout the day. Use the information to make considered decisions.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **monitor without obsessing**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

22 / FIELD GUIDE

Respond to reader questions

Prepare accurate answers about genre, content, formats, reading order and availability. If you do not know, say so and verify before replying.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **respond to reader questions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

23 / FIELD GUIDE

Manage setbacks

Prepare responses for delayed listings, damaged assets, low attendance, unavailable partners or unexpected costs. Decide what can be postponed, replaced or cancelled.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **manage setbacks**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

24 / FIELD GUIDE

Extend the campaign after launch

Plan follow-up content and outreach for the weeks after release. Use genuine reader questions and new opportunities rather than repeating the same launch announcement.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **extend the campaign after launch**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

25 / FIELD GUIDE

Review the first 7 days

Document what went live, what broke, who responded and what you learned. Separate activity metrics from outcomes and note any reporting delays.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review the first 7 days**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

26 / FIELD GUIDE

Review the first 30 days

Compare results with the original objective. Identify repeatable strengths, weak assumptions and the next best experiment.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review the first 30 days**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

27 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan the next 90 days

Choose a sustainable cadence for ongoing discovery. Include evergreen content, relevant partnerships, listing maintenance and series or backlist pathways.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan the next 90 days**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

28 / FIELD GUIDE

Protect the author’s energy

A launch can consume attention. Set work hours, delegate where possible and preserve time for writing and personal commitments. A plan that cannot be sustained is not a good plan.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **protect the author’s energy**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

29 / FIELD GUIDE

Launch readiness sign-off

Use this page to confirm that the book page, assets, links, schedule, people, budget, permissions and contingency plan are ready.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **launch readiness sign-off**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

30 / FIELD GUIDE

Post-launch learning record

Write down what you would repeat, change or stop. Keep the record with the campaign brief so future releases benefit from the experience.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **post-launch learning record**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes